Route Editor User Interface

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1 Route Editor Screen Layout

The Route Editor has many elements to the User Interface (UI) which are shown in the following image and detailed below. The main panels, or tabs, slide in and out as the mouse cursor is moved over them. They can be pinned open by clicking on the pin in the upper right hand corner of each tab.

1.1 Toolbox Tab

Click on one of the icons at the top to display that toolbox's features. The four toolboxes are:

- Objects (house icon)
- Linear Objects (track icon)
- Painting (brush icon)
- Scenarios (train icon)

Which icon you have selected dictates the contents of the browser tab underneath it.

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1.2 Browser Tab

The middle tab on the left of the screen contains the objects that can be placed into the world. The top set of icons filter the list depending on categories selected from the Asset Editor. You can select an item on the list and mouse wheel up or down the list, as well as using the scroll bar, or select any item in the list and press the first letter of the name to jump to that point of the list alphabetically.

The currently selected asset is named at the bottom of the tab. When using most painting tools this tab is mostly blank, with the exception of Paint Terrain button, where you can browse for a texture.

1.3 Options Tab

The panel on the bottom left of the screen contains the options for the toolbox currently selected on the toolbox tab.

Also on this tab are radio buttons to toggle on/off the 1024m tiles boundary lines; series and point markers (if any have been set up for the route) and a grid system.

The grid system is set to 8m spacing by default, but the value can be changed in the field next to the button. The centre of the grid is based on the current camera position and the lines of the grid draw North-South and East-West. Once an object is placed, if you have the grid displayed, dragging that object will snap it to one of the corner points of the grid.

1.4 Navigation Tab

The panel in the middle at the top of the screen contains various navigation indicators.

The compass shows the direction you are looking in. It also displays your current longitude and latitude. Edit the long/lat coordinates and select the white arrow on the bottom right of the panel to jump to those coordinates.

The 2D map button (the white sheet with an orange arrow on the left) toggles the 2D map on/off within the Editor; alternatively you can press 9 to bring up the 2D map.

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The route marker button (the grey-blue circle on the right) opens up a user-defined set of flags in the properties panel. Jump to one of these by selecting it and clicking the white arrow on the navigation panel.

1.5 Properties Tab

The panel at the top right of the screen allows you to change the properties of certain objects. The properties panel is available automatically whenever you have performed an action that permits property editing.

1.6 Status Bar

The information displayed on this bar depends on the toolbox currently selected on the toolbox panel, commonly network information based on the network piece (track, road etc) last selected or currently under the mouse. Also in the bottom left are the tile number and the asset count for that tile. If performance is slow in a particular area then it may be worth trying to lower the asset count on the surrounding tiles.

1.7 Tool Tip

Some objects in the world display information in the form of a tool tip, which hovers when the mouse is held over the object. Track information is displayed in the form of a tool tip.

1.8 Mode Select / Lock

The area at the bottom right of the screen allows you to lock certain functionality and takes you back to driving the train, which prompts a save dialogue. If you are editing a route in free play and have not selected a train then the camera will remain detached when you return to drive mode, allowing you to fly around the route and view it with the correct lighting and effects. If you entered the editor from a standard scenario, or free roam after selecting a train, you will be returned to the locomotive when switching to drive mode.

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2 Using the Display Filter

On a complete route, there may be a lot of information displayed when you enter Editor mode. This can be confusing and make selecting some objects difficult.

2.1 Using the Display Filter in the Route Editor

On the Toolbox tab is the Display button, which lets you filter the infrastructure which is being displayed in the editor. Clicking this button opens the properties tab which in this case has a selection of check boxes. Moving your mouse over an icon next to a check box brings up a tool tip showing the name of the icon.

By default, all the options are checked. This means every piece of infrastructure is displayed and can be selected.

The image below shows how the display properties tab is laid out:

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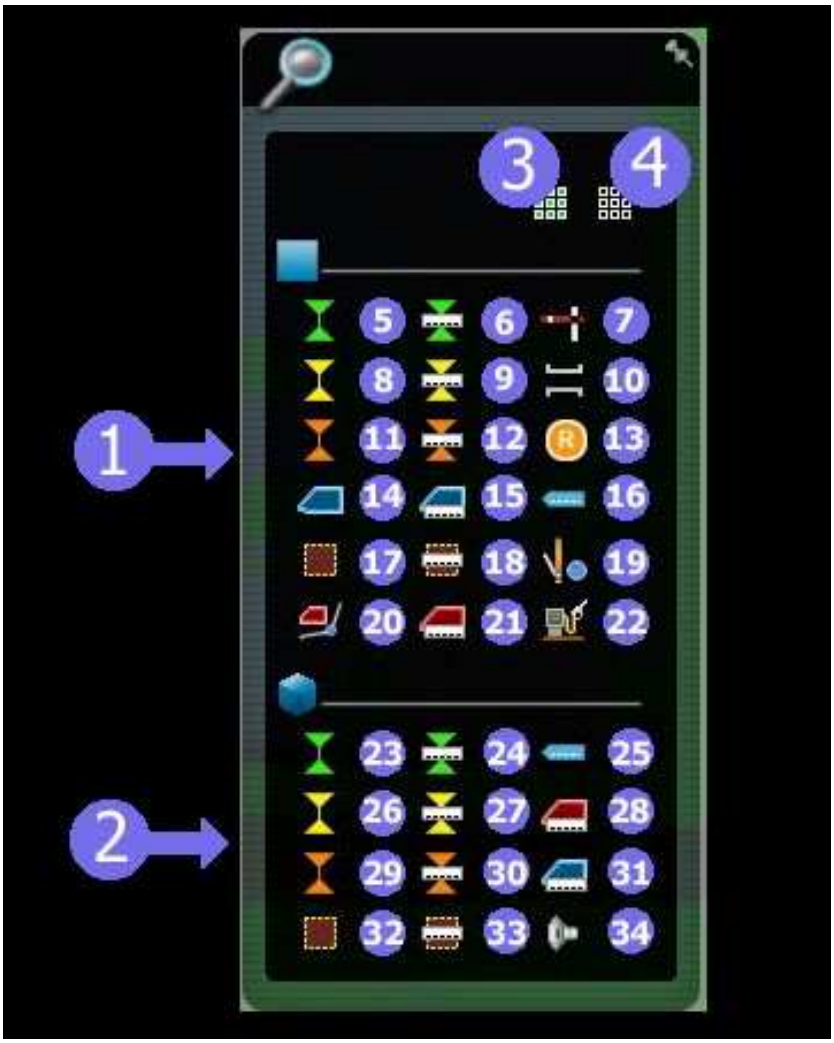

1 Affects 2D map display area
2 Affects Route Editor display area
3 Check all boxes
4 Uncheck all boxes
5 Platform Markers
6 Platform Names
7 Signals
8 Siding Markers
9 Siding Names
10 Tunnels
11 Destination Markers
12 Destination Names
13 Reversing Points
14 Non-Player Train
15 Non-Player Train Names
16 Destination Boards
17 Area Markers
18 Area Names
19 Manual Junctions
20 Immediate Paths
21 Service Names
22 Fuel Points
23 Platform Markers (Route Editor)
24 Platform Names (Route Editor)
25 Destination Boards (Route Editor)
26 Siding Markers (Route Editor)
27 Siding Names (Route Editor)
28 Player Train Names (Route Editor)
29 Destination Markers (Route Editor)
30 Destination Names (Route Editor)
31 Non-Player Train Names (Route Editor)
32 Area Markers (Route Editor)
33 Area Names (Route Editor)
34 Ambient Sounds (Route Editor)

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You can see that the properties panel is divided in half. The bottom half affects the Route editor, the top half the 2D map. Uncheck any of the boxes in the bottom half of the tab to hide the corresponding infrastructure item and make it unselectable.

Alternatively click the icon on the top right to clear all the boxes at once. In the images below you can see the effect of having all items checked and then unchecked. Once something is hidden you to select items behind it; particularly useful for the large sound markers.

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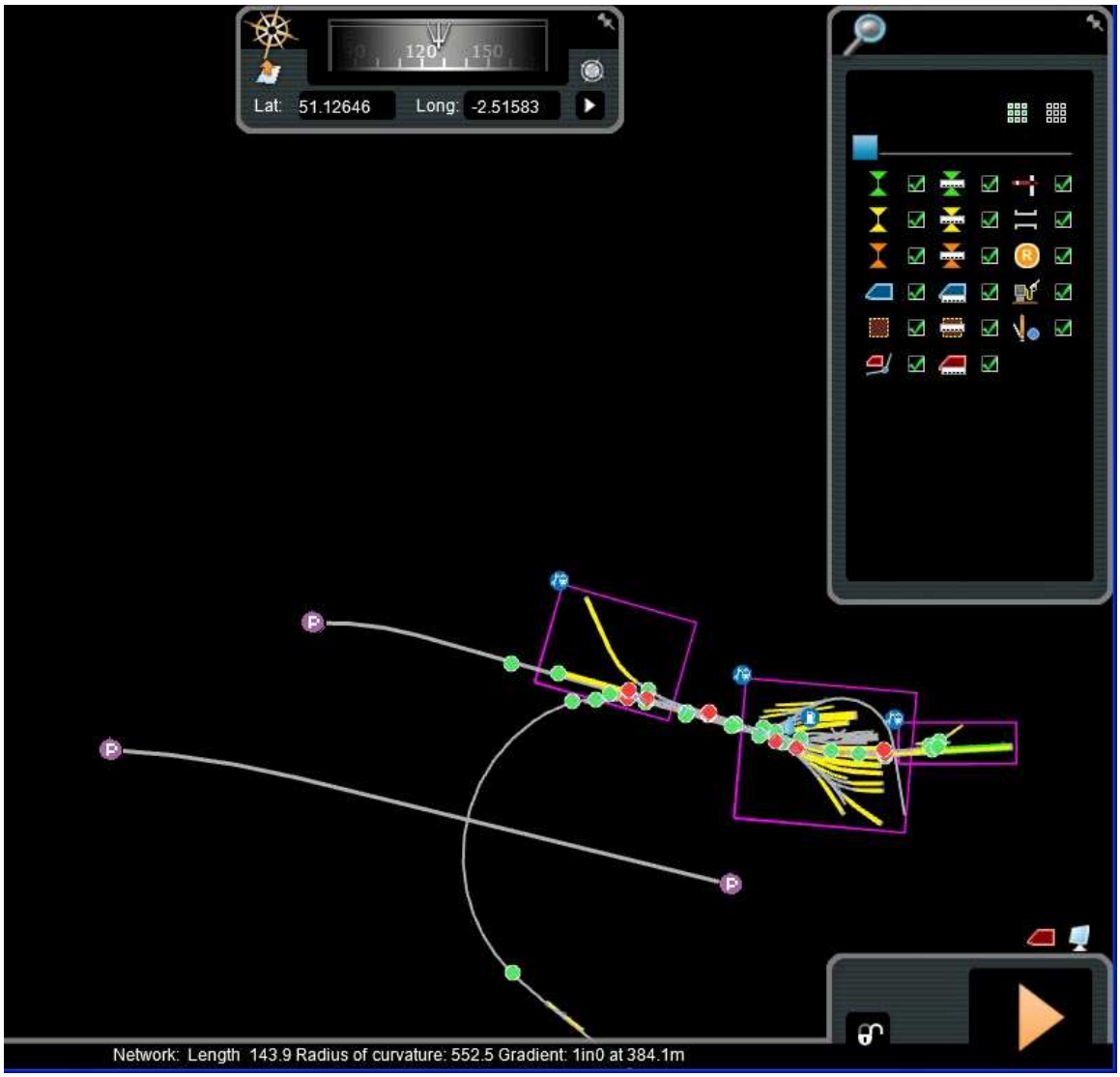
2.2 Using the Display Filter in the 2D map

With the 2D map open (by pressing the icon or 9) you can see there is a Display icon (the monitor) at the bottom right. Clicking this icon on the 2D map will also bring up the properties tab. This time, only the top half of the icons are displayed as these relate to the infrastructure displayed on the 2D map.



Again, uncheck any of the boxes in the bottom half of the tab to hide the corresponding infrastructure item.

Alternatively click the icon on the top right to clear all the boxes at once.

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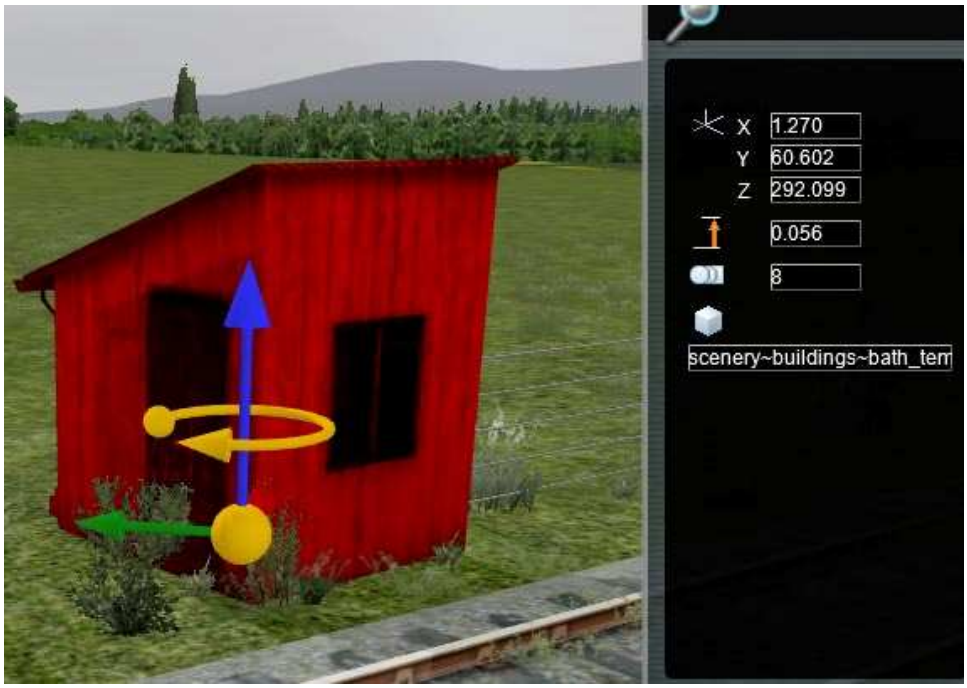
3 Using the Detail Level Slider

Another way to hide objects and preview the objects displayed on different detail level settings is to use the detail level slider which is located on the Options tab.

Grab the orange slider and move it to change the current displayed detail level. The current detail level number is displayed above the middle of the bar. Moving the slider to 10 will display more detail and moving the slider left will hide objects.

Whether an object is hidden or not is determined by the detail setting of the individual object.

Double left click an object in the world to bring up its properties. The detail level of the object is displayed; in the image below, the hut has a detail level of 8.



This means it will be visible for the top 8 detail levels. So the higher the detail level of the object the longer it will remain visible on the slider. An object with just 1 detail level will only be displayed on the top detail level (10) before it disappears.

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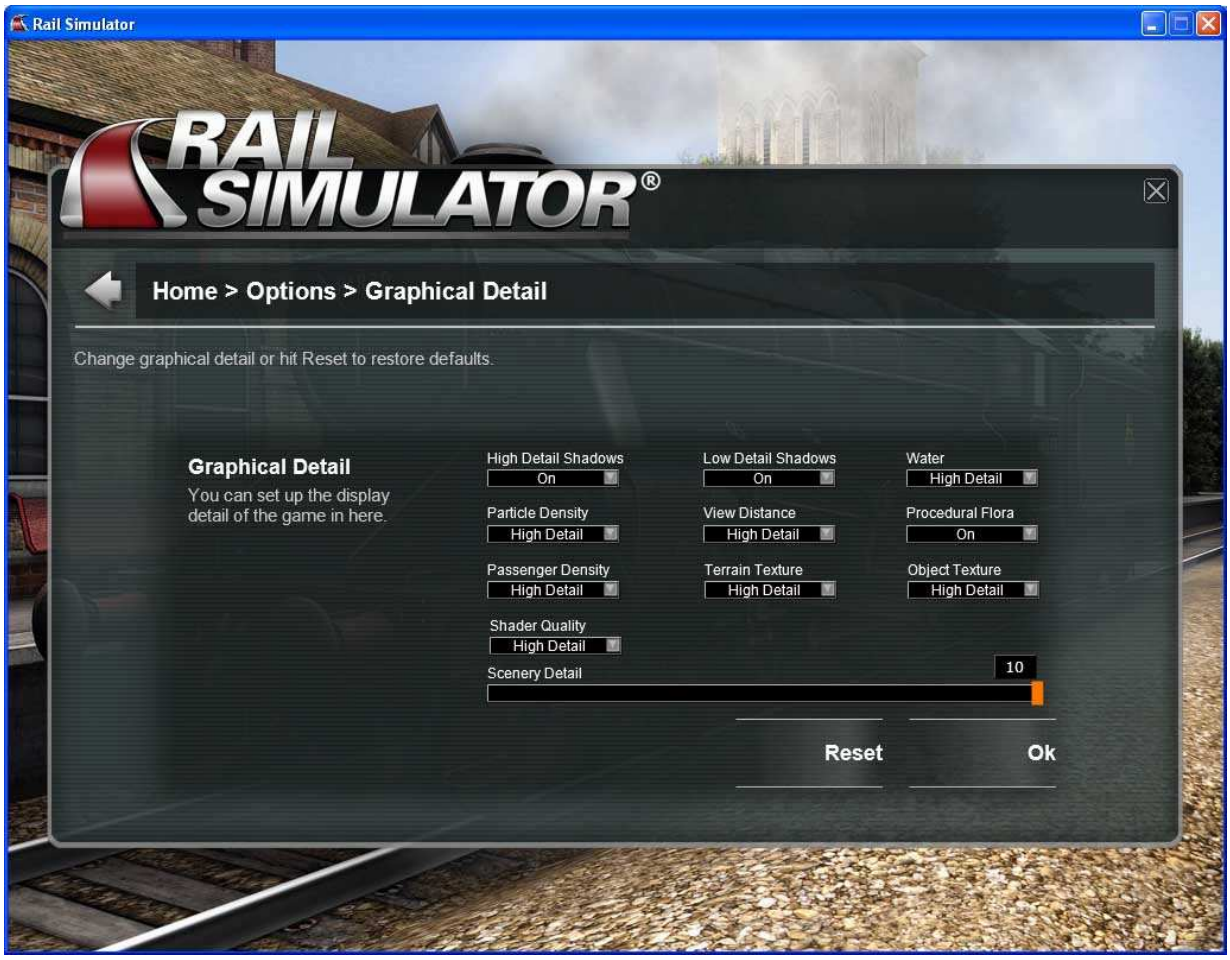
Setting object detail levels will aid performance on lower spec machines as it hides objects at low settings. The slider on the Options tab directly correlates to the slider in >Options>Graphical Detail in the front end.



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